Caleb Salt

Backend Team Lead & Engineering Manager

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EXPERIENCE

Telegraph

May 2024 – Present

Backend Team Lead / Engineering Manager

Python · FastAPI · SQLAlchemy · Pydantic · Celery · Redis · PostgreSQL · AWS · Terraform · Datadog · OpenTelemetry

Lead the backend engineering team for a rail logistics visibility platform, owning system architecture and technical standards across the API, data layer, and cloud infrastructure.

- Lead the backend team through multi-quarter platform initiatives: set technical direction, run architecture review and design documentation, and coordinate delivery with product and frontend from design through production cutover.
- Led the migration of the entire production API from Falcon to FastAPI across two production deployments, run as a phased strangler migration with in-process dual-run parity testing, byte-for-byte response comparison, and an authorization-matrix gate. Cut over 100% of traffic in a single 86-minute window with no rollback and no customer-visible errors.
- Architected the rewrite of the core data layer from waybill-centric to equipment-centric, replacing shipment-scoped visibility with a deterministic equipment state engine and a shared query layer serving both the dashboard and report builder. Unified CLM and telematics event streams behind one endpoint and closed a persistent event-association gap that had left a share of inbound events invisible to customers.
- Designed the Views framework — a declarative data-source registry, query compiler, keyset paging, and per-field permissions governed by a written contract — so new domains join by declaring their fields and binding a query. Additional data domains were onboarded with no new tables, routes, request/response models, or compiler changes.
- Unified five divergent per-feature note implementations onto a shared notes and attachment library, collapsing three separate status encodings and naive timestamps into one enum and timezone-aware UTC enforced by a shared contract test suite. Validated the production table migration against a copy of production before rollout.
- Led design and delivery of an external invoicing platform integrating EDI 210/997 for automated rail carrier billing, including price management, payee workflows, and transmission-gap alarming with operator runbooks.
- Own platform infrastructure and production readiness: Terraform-managed staging and production, OIDC CI/CD, ECS deployment circuit breakers, SOC 2 hardening, RS256/JWKS authentication, and per-route latency and error metrics via Datadog and OpenTelemetry.
- Set codebase standards — Pydantic request/response validation backing a live OpenAPI specification, Python 3.14 upgrade, test-suite parallelization and CI sharding — and introduced agent-assisted development workflows, including the written planning and session-log system used to run the FastAPI migration.

Angel Studios

April 2022 – April 2024

Senior Software Engineer, Platform Core

Python · Django · Redis · RabbitMQ · AWS · Elixir · Phoenix · GraphQL · Postgres

Drove code quality standards, development velocity, and deployment processes for the platform core team. Built internal tooling and services connecting business operations with technical systems.

- Led development of a business process manager providing centralized visibility into operational status and business intelligence.
- Led prototype of a video encoding pipeline supporting dynamic per-title configuration including 5.1/Dolby Atmos audio, variable bitrate ladders, and multi-codec compression. Projected $600K+ annual CDN savings. Established integration testing and QA processes for media assets.
- Built data aggregation service consolidating funding metrics across client projects.
- Designed and developed greenfield payments system integrating multiple vendors for international sales, financial tracking, and cross-platform transaction processing.
- Upgraded legacy Python codebase from deprecated version to current, including all dependencies and framework migrations.

TenSpot

March 2020 – April 2022

Senior Software Engineer, Backend Team Lead

Python · Django · Flask · OpenAPI · Postgres · Digital Ocean

Scaled the engineering team through technical interviews, onboarding, and mentorship. Established code quality standards and led architecture decisions for backend systems.

- Led full backend rewrite from Flask to Django, including API schema design and database restructuring to support evolving business requirements.
- Built testing framework and enforced coverage standards. Raised legacy system coverage from 3% to 70%; maintained 90%+ on new systems.
- Modernized neglected codebase with full dependency updates and established ongoing maintenance schedule.
- Integrated enterprise SSO providers including Azure Active Directory, Google, and Okta OAuth flows.
- Developed third-party vendor integrations for core platform functionality.

LenderClose

July 2019 – March 2020

Software Engineer

Python · Flask/Quart · Postgres

Built RESTful API integrations and microservices as part of a migration away from monolithic architecture.

- Developed third-party integrations enabling seamless data exchange between client systems.
- Implemented identity microservice centralizing SSO, permissions, and cross-platform authentication. Added multi-factor authentication (MFA) support.

IMT Computer Services

July 2014 – July 2019

Senior Programmer Analyst

Python · Django · EmberJS · AWS · JSONApi · MySQL · Postgres

Delivered tested, scalable systems for nearly 400 client companies in a TDD Agile environment.

- Mentored new hires and junior developers through pair programming.
- Architected Django API on AWS Elastic Beanstalk with SQS workers for asynchronous document transfer via Dropbox. Processed 50,000+ documents daily for 200 clients, replacing legacy FTP batch jobs. Created reusable django-sqs library for queue management and integration testing.
- Partnered with external vendor to build real-time SOAP data transfer service, eliminating error-prone dual manual entry.
- Migrated applications from Python 2 to Python 3 and from on-premises servers to AWS.
- Built Python communication layer enabling legacy COBOL systems to interface directly with JSON APIs, replacing flat-file intermediary workflows.

EMC Insurance Company

June 2008 – July 2014

Programmer Analyst III

Unisys BizServer · MAPPER

> P&T Claims and Finance
>
> Lead developer for workers compensation regulatory reporting system.
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> - Built EDI system for claims reporting to state regulatory bodies.
> - Developed data sharing systems to meet multi-state compliance requirements.
> - Introduced version control practices to development team.

> Personal Lines Systems
>
> Developed and maintained underwriting systems for personal lines policy quoting and management.
>
> - Built real-time coverage verification system for police report requests.
> - Created paperless document system for policy generation and archiving.